

Holistic guide — Action Checklist

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DOCUMENT YOUR CAT'S BASELINE BEHAVIOR

- ☐ **Complete a written baseline inventory covering your cat's activity patterns, food relationships, sleep locations, grooming behavior, and social navigation habits right now.:** Complete a written baseline inventory covering your cat's activity patterns, food relationships, sleep locations, grooming behavior, and social navigation habits right now.
- ☐ **Identify and record specific deviations from your cat's normal behavior patterns since sudden aggression without environmental change signals something internal has shifted.:** Identify and record specific deviations from your cat's normal behavior patterns since sudden aggression without environmental change signals something internal has shifted.
- ☐ **Track your cat's movement preferences including preferred height, territorial choices, abandonment of favorite perches, and any sudden changes in her chosen spaces over time.:** Track your cat's movement preferences including preferred height, territorial choices, abandonment of favorite perches, and any sudden changes in her chosen spaces over time.
- ☐ **Document how your cat responds to touch including where she solicits contact versus where she rejects it so tolerance changes become measurable data for your vet.:** Document how your cat responds to touch including where she solicits contact versus where she rejects it so tolerance changes become measurable data for your vet.

INVESTIGATE MEDICAL CAUSES FIRST

- ☐ **Schedule a veterinary appointment specifically to rule out pain-related causes and prepare a complete medical timeline covering aggression triggers, onset dates, and all behavioral changes.:** Schedule a veterinary appointment specifically to rule out pain-related causes and prepare a complete medical timeline covering aggression triggers, onset dates, and all behavioral changes.
 - ☐ **Request diagnostic tests for pain-related causes of aggression rather than accepting reassurance without examination since cats hide pain exceptionally well.:** Request diagnostic tests for pain-related causes of aggression rather than accepting reassurance without examination since cats hide pain exceptionally well.
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- ☐ **Push back firmly if your veterinarian dismisses sudden behavioral changes as normal aging because sudden aggression always warrants a full medical workup.:** Push back firmly if your veterinarian dismisses sudden behavioral changes as normal aging because sudden aggression always warrants a full medical workup.
- ☐ **Use a science-based reintroduction protocol that respects your cat's fear rather than forcing proximity, as pushing interaction before safety is restored causes more damage.:** Use a science-based reintroduction protocol that respects your cat's fear rather than forcing proximity, as pushing interaction before safety is restored causes more damage.

REBUILD SAFETY WITH SCIENCE-BASED STEPS

- ☐ **Monitor your own hormone changes including pregnancy, menstrual cycle shifts, or birth control changes that can alter your body chemistry and trigger defensive cat behavior.:** Monitor your own hormone changes including pregnancy, menstrual cycle shifts, or birth control changes that can alter your body chemistry and trigger defensive cat behavior.
- ☐ **Maintain household stability during periods of your own hormonal fluctuation to prevent compounding stressors that increase cat aggression risk.:** Maintain household stability during periods of your own hormonal fluctuation to prevent compounding stressors that increase cat aggression risk.
- ☐ **Keep in mind that reintroduction takes time measured in weeks, not days, and that forced interaction before safety is restored will reignite aggression episodes.:** Keep in mind that reintroduction takes time measured in weeks, not days, and that forced interaction before safety is restored will reignite aggression episodes.
- ☐ **Accept that cat fights signal an underlying problem between the animals, not bad character, and never punish cats for aggressive behavior rooted in fear or pain.:** Accept that cat fights signal an underlying problem between the animals, not bad character, and never punish cats for aggressive behavior rooted in fear or pain.

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